Political Science (M183) | Psychology (M136C)
Experiments in Racial and Ethnic Politics
Spring 2023

Teaching Associate:
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Classroom and Meeting Times:
Lab E: Thursdays, 5:00pm-5:50pm at Royce Hall 152
Lab F: Thursdays, 6:00pm-6:50pm at Royce Hall 152
Lab D: Thursdays, 7:00pm-7:50pm at Royce Hall 152

Office Hours:
Tuesdays, 4:00pm-6:00pm
Location: Zoom. Students may book office hours via Calendly.

Course Description:
This course will prepare you to take on a real-world question, design an experiment to test that question, and actually run the experiment during the course of the ten weeks we have together. It might seem overwhelming at first, but I promise this is one of the most practical and productive courses you can take at UCLA, especially if you aim to be involved with research further down the line – either as a researcher in an industry position or as a future Ph.D. student in political science or psychology.

During class time, Professor Perez will lecture and/or workshop your research questions and designs. This course has a heavy focus on learning quantitative methods to answer a research question. Therefore, we will use lab sections to 1) go over concepts that need clarification from lecture and 2) learn and practice using R for data analysis. When we receive your data from the experiments we run, you will apply your R knowledge to analyzing the data.

Many of you will already have some experience in R - that's great. But for those of you who have little to no experience in R, do not be afraid. R is an integral part of the social science research process and is the golden standard for statistical analysis. There are still plenty of things that even I don't know how to do in R! We will get through it together and we will learn together as we go.

Course Learning Objectives:

1. Gain a basic grasp of R and how to apply it to working with real-world data.
2. Learn how to use basic statistics and R as a tool to glean insights from collected data

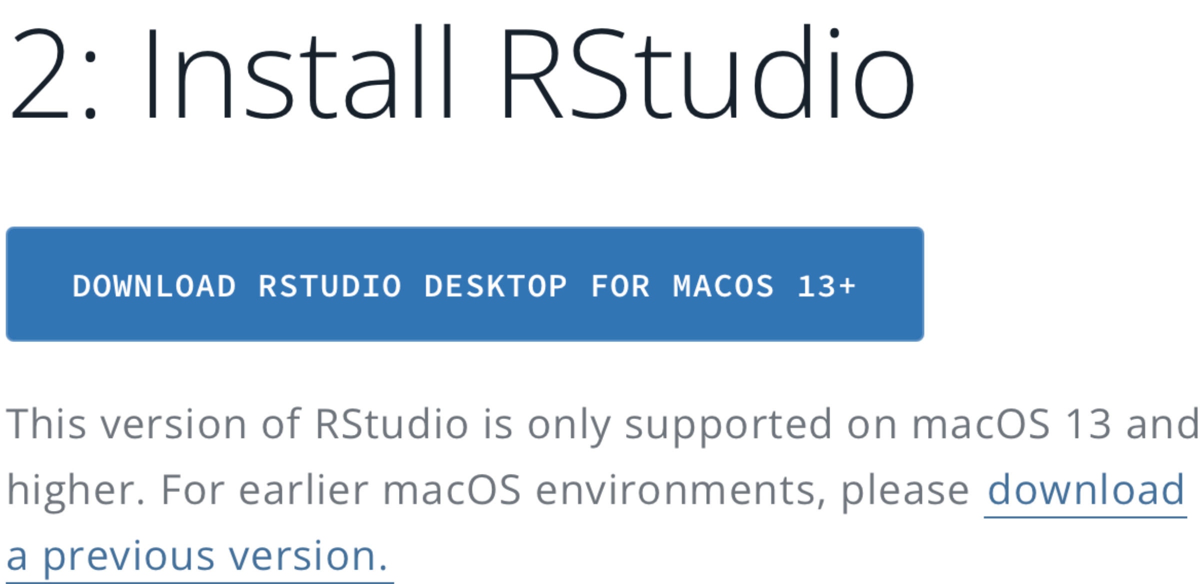
Required Software to Download:

These we will need to have installed and ready by our Week 2 section. I advise you try to do this on your own as early as possible so you have time to troubleshoot any potential issues that come up with me.

- ***Install R***

  Note: if you have already installed R and R studio you don't need to re-install, but if compatability issues arise later in the quarter, you may have to re-install
    - Go to https://cran.r-project.org/
        - Windows
            - Select "Download R for Windows"
            - Click "install R for the first time:
            - Click "Download R 4.4.3 for Windows"
        - Mac
            - Select "Download R for macOS" – Click "R-4.3.3.pkg"
- ***Install RStudio***
    - Go to https://posit.co/download/rstudio-desktop/
        - Select "Download RStudio Desktop for Windows" for Windows users
        - Select "Download RStudio Desktop for MacOs 13+" for Mac users

This is how it looks like in my Mac:



- ***Install 'tinytex'*** (for LaTeX pdf outputs)
    - Instructions for installing tinytex
        - Open up RStudio
            - In the "console" paste the following and hit return(enter)
                - **install.packages("tinytex")**
            - Once the package is installed, paste the following code in the "console" and hit return(enter):
                - **tinytex::install_tinytex()**
    - **** Note: if you have already installed LaTeX via MikTeX or MacTeX for other classes or any other reason, there is no need to install tinytex. Tinytex is typically better though since it requires less space on your computer, but doesn't have the full functionality of MikTeX or MacTeX. For this class, tinytex is more than sufficient. All we need is to make sure you can compile an Rmd into a PDF.*

Course Expectations and Obligations:
During section, please follow along with me. That means please bring a laptop or device that you can open and work in RStudio.

TA Class [Google Drive](#):
All PowerPoints used during section and R code will be posted to my Drive at the end of each week (i.e., Week 2 PPT and R script will be posted by Friday night of Week 2).

Group Work Expectations
You will all be randomly assigned a group to work with throughout the course of the quarter. These groups will be determined within your section itself –i.e., your group members will be randomly selected and assigned to you by me. If a section has 20 students, there will be two groups of 7 and one group of 6. If a section has less than 20, groups of 6 will be more likely.

You are responsible for conducting yourself in a professional and courteous manner – meaning you should all be communicating with each other and participating equally in all stages of your research development. Should any serious issues or conflicts arise with this arrangement, please let me or Professor Perez know as soon as possible. We will review any issues on group work on a case-by-case basis.

Attendance Policy:
Attendance will be taken during section, ***and you must attend the section that you have signed up for (i.e., no switching sections)***. But I also understand that life sometimes happens in which we all need to give each other a little grace. If you are unable to attend section for whatever reason, please let me know as soon as possible so we can work out a plan for working with your teammates or with me to catch up for the next section. If

you must miss a section, you should let me know how you will make up the missed section by either 1) working through the code yourself, 2) with your group members, or 3) with me during office hours.

Office Hours

You can sign up at the calendly link here: **https://calendly.com/giovannicastro-g/giovanni-office-hours**. You can either come alone for the full 30-minute appointment, or come with your group to discuss R, your research progress, or any other clarifying questions. In addition, I would love to be available to not only talk about the course, but any other questions you might have. I am sure many of you are thinking about graduate school, or weighing the benefits of a gap year, etc. Please make best use of my office hours – I would love to sit and chat with you!

Classroom Environment Expectations

We all have a responsibility to ensure that every member of the class feels valued and safe. Be mindful that our words and body language affects others in ways we might not fully understand. We have a responsibility to express our ideas in a way that doesn't make disparaging generalizations and doesn't make people feel excluded. As an instructor, I am responsible for setting an example through my own conduct.

Learning the fundamentals of a new programming language and statistics can feel overwhelming! We must create an environment where students feel comfortable asking questions and talking about what they did not understand. Discomfort is part of the learning process. Unburden yourself from the weight of being an "expert" – and remember that everyone starts somewhere, this is literally learning a new language, and it will take practice for you to actually understand what you are doing. Focus your energy on improving and helping your classmates improve.

Academic Accommodations*:*

We will work with you to create an inclusive and accessible learning environment. Students needing academic accommodations based on a disability should contact the Center for Accessible Education (CAE). When possible, students should contact the CAE within the first two weeks of the term as reasonable notice is needed to coordinate accommodations. For more information visit https://www.cae.ucla.edu/.

Additional Optional Learning Materials:

- Work through the first chapter of Introduction to R on Datacamp here
    - *Note: All first chapters of DataCamp's standard courses are free, but you will need to create an account*
- This free R for Data Science textbook

Section Schedule (Tentative - May be Adjusted)

Week 1: April 3, 2025

- ❖ DUE:
  - Review Professor Perez Syllabus
- ❖ TO DO:
  - TO DO: Download and Install R, RStudio, tinytex
  - Share emails and any other contact with other students in your team

Week 2: April 10, 2025 (R Bootcamp 1: Introduction to Tidyverse)

- ❖ *DUE:*
  - 1-page team research proposals are due by 11:59 (PST) on 4/11 on Bruin Learn. You will receive feedback to develop this brief proposal into a fuller one (~5,000 words).
- ❖ TO DO:
  - Make sure you find time to meet with Professor Perez to discuss your research ideas!
  - Finish R Bootcamp 1 if we do not finish in class

Week 3: April 17, 2025 (R Bootcamp 2: Data Manipulation with Tidyverse)

- ❖ TO DO:
  - Finish R Bootcamp 2 if we do not finish in class
- ❖ OPTIONAL:
  - R Practice 1 (for additional practice)

Week 4: April 24, 2025 (R Bootcamp 3)

- ❖ *DUE:*
  - Revised Research Proposal + Response Memo
- ❖ TO DO:
  - Participate in REPS Study
  - Finish R Bootcamp 3 if we do not finish in class

Week 5: May 1, 2025 (R Bootcamp 4: Intro to Data Analysis + R Practice 2)

- ❖ TO DO:
  - Finish R Bootcamp 4 if we do not finish in class
  - Finish R Practice 2 with your teams if you didn't finish in class

Week 6: May 8, 2025 (R Bootcamp 5: Practicing Data Analysis)

- *DUE:*
  - Revised Research Proposal + Response Memo: due on May 11 (Sunday) by 11:59pm.
- TO DO:
  - SUBMIT R Bootcamp 5 to Shared Drive for participation grade

Week 7: Work on Data Analysis/Final Papers in Groups

- TO DO:
  - Schedule time with me and your team to discuss article draft progress before the quarter ends and/or help with data analysis code
    - (Regular time): Tuesday, May 13th 4:00pm – 6:00pm
    - (Expanded time): Thursday, May 15th 4:00pm – 6:00pm

Week 8: Work on Data Analysis/Final Papers in Groups

- TO DO:
  - Schedule time with me and your team to discuss article draft progress before the quarter ends and/or help with data analysis code
    - (Regular time): Tuesday, May 20th 4:00pm – 6:00pm
    - (Expanded time): Thursday, May 22th 4:00pm – 6:00pm

Week 9: Work on Data Analysis/Final Papers in Groups

- TO DO:
  - Schedule time with me and your team to discuss article draft progress before the quarter ends and/or help with data analysis code
    - (Regular time): Tuesday, May 27th 4:00pm – 6:00pm
    - (Expanded time): Thursday, May 29th 4:00pm – 6:00pm

Week 10: Work on Data Analysis/Final Papers in Groups

- *DUE:*
  - The final team paper is due by 6:00pm (PST) on Friday, June 13
- TO DO:
  - Schedule time with me and your team to discuss article draft progress before the quarter ends and/or help with data analysis code
    - (Regular time): Tuesday, June 3rd 4:00pm – 6:00pm
    - (Expanded time): Thursday, June 5th 4:00pm – 6:00pm